Functions

- Production of red blood cells.
- It is readily absorbed from intestines.
- Improves immunity.
- Improves nervous system functions.
- Reduces muscle spasms, cramps and numbness.
- Maintains proper balance of sodium and phosphorous in the body.

Food sources of Pyridoxine: Good food sources include whole grains, legumes, bananas, potato, liver, kidney and other meats, fortified breads and cereals. Sunflower seeds, soya beans, walnuts and yeast are the richest sources of pyridoxine among plant foods.

Symptoms of Pyridoxine deficiency

- Nervousness, Insomnia, Anaemia, oedema, mental depression.
- Loss of muscle control, muscle weakness, tooth decay.
- Arm and leg cramps,
- Water retention,
- Skin lesions and skin disorder.

11.3.5 Vitamin B_9 (Folic Acid)

Vitamin B_9 includes both folate and folic acid and is important for several functions in the body. It is important for women who are pregnant to consume enough folic acid.

Functions of folic acid: The different functions of folate include:

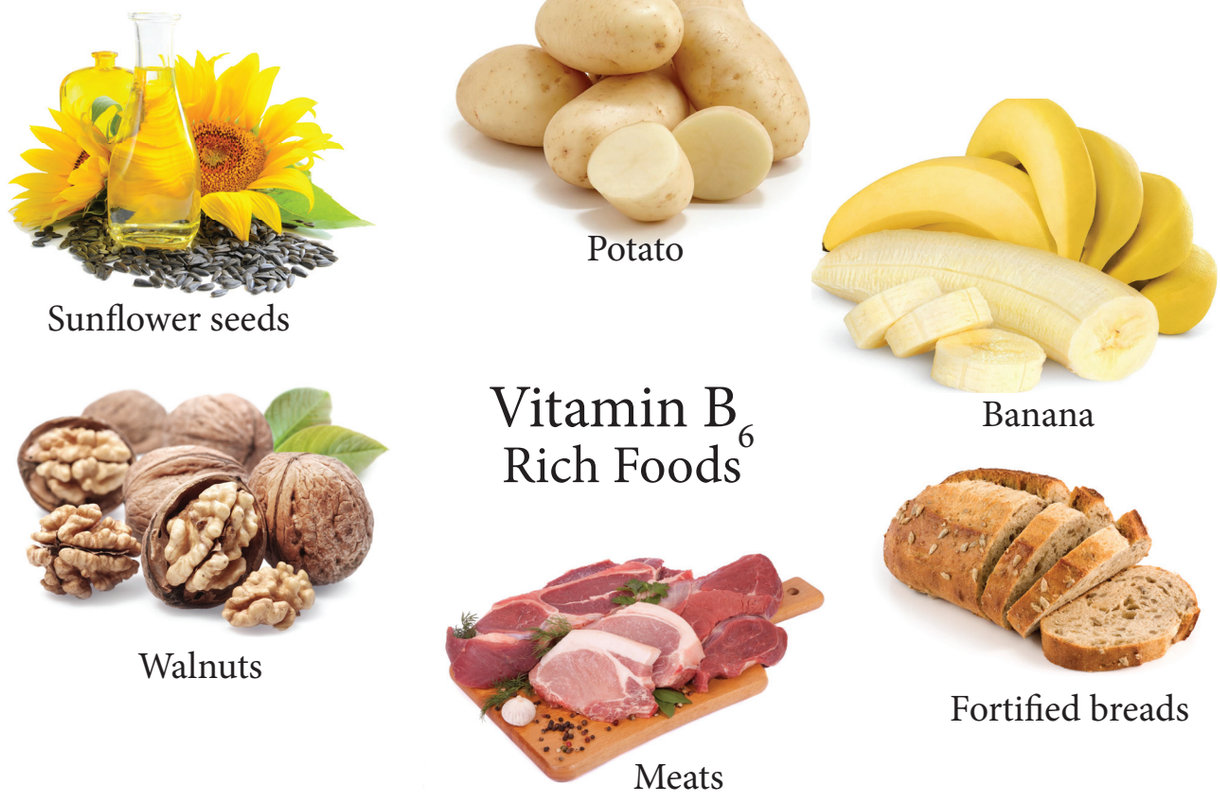


Fig 11.14: Food Sources of Vitamin B_6

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